

HONOR

In the Bible, Honor is a really big deal. Even though the word is rarely used in the Bible, the principle of Honor stretches from one end of the Bible to the other. Honor is literally a common thread that begins with the index and concludes with the maps.

Honor is also a very desirable human trait. People who have it and display it are always influential people, those who do not have it and fail to display it, are basically tolerated by everyone in their circle of influence.

In Hebrew, the word for honor means to weigh down (with respect and esteem); the opposite is to treat lightly. One does not have to be a horse's end to fail to display honor, the lack of respect and esteem equal's dishonor.

The Greek word for honor is “ti-me” (tee-MAY). It means “to value, to respect, or to highly esteem. ” It was usually associated with a way to assign value.

The Bible tells us that there are people and things that we are to give a place of honor, because of their great value.

Honor has fallen on hard times in our culture. Lawlessness = No name! Lawlessness is really an identity crisis. An identity crisis develops when respect is lost and honor falls on hard times. In this culture, independence is worshipped and honor is despised.

Over the next couple of Sundays, I’m going to drill down on honor and I am going to come for everyone including myself on this subject! We are going to talk about:

- Honoring our parents...
- Honoring each other...
- Honoring authorities...

- Honoring marriage...
- Honoring God...

HONORING PARENTS

Deuteronomy 5:16 ***“Honor your father and mother, as the Lord your God commanded you. Then you will live a long, full life in the land the Lord your God is giving you.”*** The King James version of this say’s ***“Things will go well with you, and you will live long upon the earth.”*** This passage demonstrates that honoring our parents can cause the path of life to be much better and actually lengthen our life spans. Conversely, showing a lack of honor to our parents creates unnecessary difficulty and can shorten our lives.

We are to recognize the great value that God has placed on our parents. (Story of my dad saying, *“That’s my boy.”*)

As a child, we often think our parents are being harsh and unreasonable. It is amazing how smart and compassionate our parents seem, when we have children of our own.

HONOR EACH OTHER

Psalm 8:4-5 *“What are mere mortals that you should think about them, human beings that you should care for them? Yet you made them only a little lower than God and crowned them with glory and honor.”*

We are to recognize the great value that God has placed on humanity. This society has devalued the human being. God highly values every person. *“He is not willing that ANYONE should perish, but that EVERYONE would come to repentance.”*

The word tells us here that people have been crowned with great honor:

- Not just the rich people...
- Not just the intelligent people...

- Not just the talented people...

All people! All human beings have been crowned with great honor! Look down your row, there is probably someone on your row that you do not think deserves honor – God honors them and we must do the same!

The Hebrew word used here means, "*The object is beautiful and instills awe.*" When God looks at us, our beauty awes him.

- When God looks at a righteous person, their beauty awes Him...
- When God looks at a homeless person, his/her beauty awes him...
- When God looks at a person with a sinful lifestyle, their beauty awes him...

What do we do with something that is beautiful and instills awe?

- We treasure it...
- We protect it...

- We highly value it...
- We position it in a place of honor...

Some things we may even be willing to lay our lives down for.

This is exactly why Jesus laid down His life for

- Me...
- You...
- The righteous person...
- The homeless person...
- The person living a sinful lifestyle...

Remember: We have never locked eyes with anyone that God doesn't love!

HONOR THOSE IN AUTHORITY

We are to recognize the great value that God has placed on those in authority. The concept is to not just respect them but to give those in authority over us, special treatment. This is a difficult concept for us.

We live in a world that highly values individuality. We do not want anyone telling us what to do, or making demands of us. But God commands us to treat our bosses, governmental officials, and spiritual authorities with the honor that their position deserves.

As Christians, we are to be respectful in our relationship with them, realizing that no one holds a position of authority that God has not allowed.

1 Thessalonians 5:12 ***“Dear brothers and sisters, honor those who are your leaders in the Lord’s work. They work hard among you and give you spiritual guidance.”***

We are to recognize the great value that God has placed on those in spiritual authority.

Have you ever been a participant in bringing dishonor to a leader? This can occur in the following ways:

- Not recognizing them for their hard work...
(We often fail to recognize that while leaders make mistakes, they have made far more good choices than bad choices)
- Not accepting their experienced guidance...
(I would be as lost as a ball in high weeds trying to pick a CEO for Exxon – But I bet because of my experience, I can pick a great pastor for almost any kind of church – Just because you are successful in another field doesn't mean you know enough to tell a spiritual authority how to do things)
- Rebelling against their authority... (All rebellious people are rebels!)
- Leading a coup against a spiritual authority... (Deacon who said, *"I would rather you hand me a live rattlesnake..."*)

When people refuse to submit to, or follow the directions of those in authority, they normally

think, “*If I was in charge I would do things differently.*” Guess what? We are not in charge, and for good reason.

The reason is that we have yet to submit to those in authority, or follow the directions of a person in charge. In this scenario, if God allowed us to be in charge we would soon implode, bringing harm to the organization and everyone involved.

One thing is for sure; disobedience in following the principal of honoring those in authority will exact a high price, from the person who refuses to submit and honor.

When we CHOOSE to honor (trust) those in spiritual authority, we enact the favor and blessing of God upon our lives.

We must learn to respect those that are over us. We must honor our supervisors, governmental leaders and spiritual authorities, and as we do, we bring them honor and bring blessings into our lives.

HONOR MARRIAGE

Hebrews 13:4 *“Give honor to marriage, and remain faithful to one another in marriage. God will surely judge people who are immoral and those who commit adultery.”*

We are to honor the institution of marriage.

We are to recognize the great value that God has placed upon marriage. Not just our marriage but also all marriages. We are not to behave in any manner that would bring dishonor to another

person's marriage, or to bring dishonor our own marriage.

We must be careful that our actions or words not lead to the termination of someone's marriage, including our own.

If we are married, we must remain faithful to one another, so that honor will be shown to the institution of marriage.

- For better or worse...
- For richer or poorer...
- In sickness and in health...
- Until death do us part...

God does not take it lightly when a sacred institution that He established is dishonored. To do so is to bring judgment upon ourselves.

1 Corinthians 6:18-20 (NKJV) ***“Flee from sexual immorality. All other sins a person commits are outside the body, but whoever sins sexually, sins against their own body. ¹⁹ Do you***

not know that your bodies are temples of the Holy Spirit, who is in you, whom you have received from God? You are not your own; ²⁰ you were bought at a price. Therefore honor God with your bodies.”

1 Peter 3:7 “In the same way, you husbands must give honor to your wives. Treat your wife with understanding as you live together. She may be weaker than you are, but she is your equal partner in God’s gift of new life. Treat her as you should so your prayers will not be hindered.”

Men, we are to honor their wives. We are to recognize the great value that God has placed on our wives. We are to treat them with understanding and great respect.

ILLUSTRATION:

A man walking along a California beach was deep in prayer when all of a sudden he said

aloud, *"Lord grant me one wish"*. The sky clouded and a booming voice said, *"Because you have tried to be faithful I will grant you one wish."* The man said, *"Build a bridge to Hawaii so I can drive over anytime I want to."*

The Lord answered, *"Your request is very materialistic. Think of the logistics of that kind of undertaking; the supports required to reach the bottom of the Pacific; the concrete and steel it would take. I can do it, but it is hard for me to justify your desire for worldly things. Take a little more time to think of another wish, a wish you think would honor and glorify me"*.

The man thought for a long time and finally said, *"Lord, I wish that I could understand my wife. I want to know what she feels inside, what she is thinking when she gives me the silent treatment, why she cries, what she means when she says 'nothing' to my question of 'what's wrong?' and how I can make her truly happy?"*

After a few minutes God said, *"How many lanes do you want on that bridge?"*

Ladies, honestly, there are times when we really don't understand. But God has told us to treat you with special treatment.

If we do not treat our wives with respect and honor, the Word says, our prayers will be hindered.

Women are to live in a way that brings honor to their husbands. What does this kind of honor look like?

- They are to submit to their husbands as the spiritual priest of their homes.
- They are to obey the direction of their husbands, as long as that direction does not lead them to dishonor the Lord.
- They are to dress and behave in a way that brings honor to their husbands and families.

HONOR GOD

We are to recognize the great value that God places upon himself, and we should reciprocate by valuing Him above all else.

God is valuable and He realizes it. He says of himself, ***“You will have no other God’s above me, because I am a jealous God.”***

He is the creator of everything. He is in control of everything around us.

He gave us the life and health that we enjoy. He paid a high price so that you and I can honor him with service and righteous living.

To live a corrupt lifestyle brings dishonor to him.

God doesn’t deserve honor, He deserves double honor.

Honoring God begins with our finances.

Proverbs 3:9 *“Honor the Lord with your wealth and with the best part of everything you produce.”*

In a recent study, the Barna Research group discovered that only four percent of professing Christians tithe! I say all real Christians do tithe.

Tithing is giving a minimum of ten percent of your income to the church you attend. The average Christian gives 2.56% of their income. A staggering 25% give nothing at all. The average tip given to a server at a restaurant is 16%. **(Write these stats on a white board)**

We have apps on our phones to assist us in tallying what the proper amount the tip should be. Almost everyone feels obligated to leave a tip of somekind.

In a survey done by Deal News, 56% of those surveyed tipped in spite of lousy service. The reason given; *“So that the person tipping would not be looked upon in a negative manner.”*

We worry about what a person who brought us food and filled our glasses thinks of us, and we should, while we give very little consideration to the one who has the power of life and death in His very hands. Luke 12:5 (NKJV) ***“And I say to you, My friends, do not be afraid of those who kill the body, and after that have no more that they can do. ⁵ But I will show you whom you should fear: Fear Him who, after He has killed, has power to cast into hell; yes, I say to you, fear Him!”***

When we tip, we are giving honor for the service rendered. **We should ask ourselves the following questions:**

- Has God saved us?
- Has God rescued us?
- Has God healed us?

- Has God delivered us?
- Has God ever served us?

56% of the population felt that even bad service, deserved something. What about God?

The tithe is a baseline requirement. Tithing doesn't make us generous; it makes us compliant; our offerings make us generous.

Paul wrote ***“You must each decide in your heart how much to give. And don't give reluctantly or in response to pressure. “For God loves a person who gives cheerfully.” (2 Corinthians 9:7)***

We are to give to God, not out of sorrow or guilt; not under distress, but rather give with a thankful attitude.

We are to honor God:

- With our giving...
- With our living... (Lifestyle)

- With our hearts...
- With our service...
- With our prayers...
- With our families...
- With our careers...
- With our ministries...

HONOR OURSELVES

It sounds strange indeed to say that we are to honor ourselves! This simply means, that **we are to recognize the great value that God places on each of us.**

God has an order to everything He does. When we begin to honor those things required of us; parents, humanity, authorities, church leaders, marriage, wives, husbands, and God; He begins to exalt us in the heavens! And **whatever, or whoever, He exalts in the heavens will most certainly be exalted in the earth.**

Mankind is the crowning creation of God. We cannot deface or devalue His greatest creation and expect to receive His blessing.

We must be careful about:

- Inferior thoughts... (Self-hate)
- Inferior actions... (Low self-esteem)
- Habits that are harmful... (***“We are the temple of the Holy Spirit... Whoever destroys the temple, him will God destroy.”***)
- Self-destructive lifestyles... (We have the power of choice. Choose life!)
- Talking down His creation... (***“Life and death is in the power of the tongue.”***)

The world has devalued us but God is going to highly exalt us, IN DUE TIME! Do we agree with the world or do we agree with God?

- God actually brags about us to the enemy. (Job)

- He rejoices over us in joyful songs.
(Zephaniah 3:17)
- He sings songs of victory about us. (Psalm 32:7)

We have an appointed season for these things in our life. Let's not hinder our appointed season, but rather live with expectations of its arrival. Let's show honor where honor is due.

END OF LESSON 2

Honoring authority means to respect and value those in authority over us. We should willingly do this because of the influence and responsibility they carry for our lives. Romans 13:1 (NKJV) ***“Let every soul be subject to the governing authorities. For there is no authority except from God, and the authorities that exist are appointed by God.”***

Here are some facts about honoring those who are in authority:

- Every person alive is under some type of authority, and will be until the day they die...
- Honoring authority is a God-thing, not a man-made thing...
- By honoring authority, we honor God...
- By dishonoring authority, we dishonor God...
- Authority is about influence and responsibility...
- Honoring authority is meant to work to our advantage, not to our disadvantage...
- God uses authority to establish order...
- Authority comes out of God's order, not necessarily rank or seniority...

The purpose of authority is as follows:

- Authority is in place to guide us...

- Authorities set boundaries for our protection...
- Authorities set and inflict penalties for injustices done...
- Authorities arbitrate matters of disagreement...
- Authorities give counsel when direction is needed...

According to Scripture, spiritual authorities:

- Keep watch over our souls...
- Raise us up and train us for ministry...
- Release us into destiny...
- Love us, encourage us, disciple us, and discipline us...
- Prepare the way for those behind them...

Practical ways to honor authority:

- Love them unconditionally... (I Peter 4:8)

- Submit to them cheerfully... (Hebrews 13:17; 1 Peter 2:13-17) Submit = A voluntary attitude of giving in, cooperating, assuming responsibility, and carrying a burden)
- Protect their families... (Silence is consent – Story about three boys talking about what their dad’s did for a living – First boy - “*My dad writes poems and gets money for it.*” Second boy – “*My dad writes songs and gets money for it.*” _ Third boy – “*My dad writes and preaches sermons and it takes four men to carry the money he gets for it.*”)
- Serve them gladly... (Galatians 5:13; Ephesians 6:5-8)
- Give them double honor... (1 Timothy 5:17-18)
- Don’t infringe on their personal time... (Mark 6:30-31)

- Pray for them unceasingly... (1 Timothy 2:1-3)
- Make their vision our vision... (2 Timothy 2:1-3)

Final thoughts:

1 Timothy 5:17 ***“The elders who direct the affairs of the church well are worthy of double honor, especially those whose work is preaching and teaching.”***

Why does the Bible say this? Pastors have more challenges to face than the normal person:

- They are pressured to have an ideal family... (4 out of 5 pastors nationwide feel their family are negatively impacted by the ministry and that it is an outright hazard to the health of their family)
- They face stress as they try to meet the demands of a growing or declining congregation... (Shepherds don't beget sheep, sheep do)

- They face financial crunches in their family and in the church... (Most pastors are underpaid)
- They carry the load of all the families they lead, rather than just their own...
- They are on call 24/7... (There is no down time)